Bellwether · Your turn

Choose one action

Operate: play one to three cards, finishing each before choosing another. For each common card, choose an open party and an agent positioned to perform its Operation. Party cards need an open party but no nearby agent. Firm cards need no party. You may choose a different party for each card.

Collect: spend a Collection counter. Take any open party's Operation pile and one available party card into New Year. The party stays open.

Close: close a party bearing your Firm marker. Take its Operation pile and one available party card into New Year, then return your marker. You cannot Close on your first Lobby turn of the year.

Pass: you may pass only when all your Firm markers have returned.

After your turn: if more than half the Firm markers used for Party Openings have returned, end the year. Otherwise, play continues clockwise.

Parties and Operations

An open party is available to everyone. Its Firm marker determines who receives its Closure, not who may use it.

Choose a party with Support in your agent's district:

Organise	Move one of that party's Support to a neighbouring district with space. Your agents there may follow, subject to your firm's rules.
Rally	Add one of that party's Support to a free spot there.
Smear	Remove one other party's Support from there or a neighbouring district.

Agents use no Support spaces. Districts are neighbours when they share a border, not just a corner. Follow your firm helper for special agent permissions and connections.

Absent-party recovery: if the party has no Support anywhere, Organise or Rally adds one at your agent's district; Smear removes one rival Support there. Recovery Organise carries no agents.

Laws

Use the chosen party's laws, whoever performs the Operation. Global laws affect everyone.

Different laws combine; duplicates do not stack. Apply each law at most once per card. Law extras do not trigger further extras or require additional agents. Resolve mandatory extras when possible; skip them otherwise.

Party cards perform their printed effects. They do not use Operation laws or carry agents.

Where cards go

Common card	Chosen party's Operation pile
Party card	Its home party
Firm card	New Year, unless placed on the board
Hecate reward card	Hecate's reward supply

Reward cards use normal card slots and common Operation requirements.

New Year is set aside, not your hand. You cannot play those cards until they return to hand at year-end. Keep their contents private and their total count visible. Hand contents and private priorities are secret; hand size and party piles are public.

Bellwether · Year & Elections

Starting reminder

One firm and one private priority card per player.

Players	Firm markers	Collection counters	Starting common cards
4–6	1	2	3 Organise, 4 Rally, 2 Smear
2–3	2	4	6 Organise, 8 Rally, 4 Smear

Set up the board using the rulebook, then complete each firm's setup in order **1–6**. Agents and firm-card supplies do not double at lower player counts.

Start each year

1. **Resurgence:** identify every party with no Support on the board. Starting with Early Bird, each player adds one Support of each identified party to any free spots. Complete one trip around the players; skip additions if no space remains.
2. **Party Openings:** place a Firm marker on a party without one. Fiddler opens first, then go clockwise from Early Bird, skipping Fiddler. Without Fiddler, start with Early Bird. At 2–3 players, reverse this order for a second opening round.
3. **Fiddler's favours:** resolve last year's favours using the firm helper.
4. **Lobby:** Early Bird takes the first turn; continue clockwise.

End the year

1. Close remaining parties in Firm order **1–6**. Each marker's owner takes the pile and one available party card into New Year, then returns the marker. Players with two parties choose their Closure order.
2. After Years **2, 4 and 6**, hold an Election.
3. Return New Year cards to hand. Agents stay on the board.
4. For another year, refresh Collection counters and Firm markers. The player whose turn ended the year becomes Early Bird.

After Year 6, score the game instead of starting another year.

Election

1. **Thin Support:** outside Centre, randomly retain up to half each district's capacity—1, 2 or 3 Support in districts with 2, 4 or 6 spaces. Keep all if fewer are present. Centre keeps all its Support.
2. **Vote:** each remaining Support casts one vote on its region's policy, following its party's printed For/Against position. More For than Against passes; ties fail.
3. **Award laws:** give each passed Party law to the party contributing the most For votes in that region. Break ties using the leftmost tied party in the printed For row. Keep Global laws in the shared display. Discard failed policies.
4. Count all regions before activating new laws. Resolve Election prophecies before returning New Year cards.
5. After Elections 1 and 2, reveal a new policy for each region. After Election 3, proceed to final scoring.

Final scoring

Policies: reveal your private priorities. For every enacted policy, gain your value for its **+ issue** and lose your value for its **− issue**. Every enacted policy scores for everyone, regardless of who received its law. Apply Global scoring laws.

Hand ranking: after returning New Year cards, count your common and party cards. Fiddler also counts each remaining favour as one card. Exclude firm and reward cards.

Gain **one point for each other player whose count is equal to or lower than yours**.

Highest total wins. Tied players share victory.